d. Give two reasons for the decline in the number of sparrows.

Importance of sparrows

5. Every organism in this planet has its own role to play in the web of interconnected life. These enchanting tiny birds help in maintaining the ecological balance. A sparrow is an important member of various urban and natural food chains and food webs. It feeds on grains like rice, wheat etc. and also on larva of mosquitoes. This mechanism is a natural pest control process which helps human beings. Sparrows assist in the process of pollen transfer thus leading to pollination of the flower. Sparrows are loved by young and old. These lovable and charming birds bring prosperity to us. Our children have always enjoyed watching them and entertain themselves by singing songs related to sparrows.

e. Why is the sparrow important in food chains and food webs?

Sparrow Conservation

6. World Sparrow Day is celebrated to raise awareness and create a platform to highlight the need to conserve sparrows and the bio-diversity of this earth.



- Creating awareness about these birds seems to be the key to their survival. World Sparrow Day is a step in the right direction.
- As always individual efforts count the most and all it takes is a pot with a small hole that is hung anywhere outside to attract sparrows.
- There are many online sparrow monitoriing projects, where bird enthusiasts record sightings of sparrows. The Nature Forever Society, based in Pune, is running a similar programme, viz Common Bird Monitoring of India.

f. Why should we save this small, common bird?

For instance, in October, 2012 the Delhi government has declared the house sparrow as the State Bird. It is a milestone in the conservation of the bird and has been done to lay emphasis on the magnitude of action required to conserve the small birds. It is time to take effective action to conserve the tiny social bird. It is our responsibility to save this small, lovable, beautiful and harmless bird for environment conservation. It requires a part of your heart and a little effort that may create an impact in the life system of house sparrows.

Glossary

decline(adj) : decreasing/ weakening

adapted(v) : to adjust according to the surroundings

habitat(n) : a place in which one lives

distinct(adj) : prominent, clear

peculiar(adj) : odd, unusual

flicker (v) : make small quick movements

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